

MINISTER SPEAKS

Bhupender Yadav,
Environment Minister

For developing countries to pursue low-carbon growth, developed nations must move beyond promises and provide tangible support—through finance and technology access—Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav said.

“The civilisation we live in is energy-based—whether it’s railways or rockets, factories or homes, all run on power. But with every unit consumed, there’s a cost: carbon emissions. If the West has gained from industrial progress, it should also support countries addressing basic development needs,” he said.



CLIMATE DIPLOMACY

(From left) **Karishma Asoodani**, Special Correspondent, BTTV
Shailendra Bhatnagar, Chief Analyst and Editor, Markets, BT
Vaibhav Chaturvedi, Senior Fellow, CEEW
Jaivardhan Ramanlal Bhatt, Distinguished Fellow, RIS
Nilanjan Ghosh, VP and Senior Director, ORF

“The trade-off always existed between growth and environmental concerns. Climate change is the cost of growth and we have ignored that. Climate change is not an environmental problem, it is a developmental problem,” said Ghosh.

“In 2023, the intergovernmental panel on climate change produced the 6th assessment report and said that starting from 1850 to 2019, the whole of SouthAsia – 24 per cent of the human population, and it includes India – contributed just 4% of emissions. I am not talking about per capita emissions,” Bhatt said.

“The answer is in both science and social science. The science part is that the climate debate is not about annual emissions, it is about the stock of emissions in the atmosphere. Historically India’s emissions have been very low,” Chaturvedi said.